

COLUMBUS TRADE ASSOCIATION

BOARD OF DIRECTORS MEETING

Minutes of the Regular Monthly Meeting

Date:	February 19, 2026
Time:	5:30 PM to 7:12 PM
Location:	Midtown Conference Center, Room 214, 400 N. High Street, Columbus, OH 43215
Called to Order by:	President, Carolyn Adkins

BOARD MEMBERS PRESENT

Name	Title / Affiliation
Carolyn Adkins	President, Adkins Global Trade LLC
Jason Robert Kim	Board Member, Kim Trade Services
Marcus Webb	Treasurer, Webb Import Solutions
Priya Okonkwo	Secretary, OhioAg Export Consulting
Ray Hendricks	Board Member, Hendricks Freight Partners
Teresa Bautista	Board Member, Central Ohio Manufacturers Assn.
David Nguyen	Board Member, Nguyen Compliance Group

Absent (Excused): Frank Castellano, Riverview Trade Finance

1. CALL TO ORDER AND QUORUM

President Adkins called the meeting to order at 5:30 PM. A quorum of seven of eight voting board members was confirmed present. The minutes of the January 15, 2026 regular meeting were approved as distributed without amendment. Motion by Marcus Webb, seconded by Ray Hendricks. Vote: 7-0 in favor.

2. TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Webb presented the January 2026 financial summary. Operating account balance: \$47,318.44. Annual membership dues collected to date: \$38,200.00 against a full-year budget of \$52,000.00. Event sponsorship revenue for Q1 conferences: \$9,400.00. Expenses are within budget. No action required.

3. TARIFF POLICY UPDATE DISCUSSION

Board member Kim presented a summary of recent CBP guidance on Section 301 tariff exclusion reinstatement procedures, noting that the window for exclusion requests had been reopened for certain

HTS chapters relevant to Central Ohio manufacturers. Kim recommended the Association circulate a member advisory and offer a free webinar before the end of February. The board approved the advisory distribution. Kim and David Nguyen volunteered to co-present the webinar. Scheduling to be confirmed by Pat Delgado at Kim Trade Services.

4. COLUMBUS TRADE MENTORSHIP PROGRAM UPDATE

Board member Kim provided an update on the Columbus Trade Mentorship Program, co-founded with Ryan Montoya of Montoya Logistics. The current cohort includes eleven participants from six member firms. The spring session schedule has been finalized. Kim requested a modest budget allocation of \$1,200.00 for printed materials and the end-of-cohort reception. Motion to allocate: Priya Okonkwo. Second: Teresa Bautista. Vote: 7-0. Full program details are in d2.docx.

5. SPRING TRADE CONFERENCE PLANNING

The annual Spring Trade and Compliance Conference is scheduled for October 22-23, 2026, at the Hilton Columbus Downtown. Venue contract has been signed. Registration will open in late September. Priya Okonkwo to lead speaker recruitment. Board members are encouraged to suggest two to three speakers each by the end of February. Sponsorship packets to be distributed to member firms in early October.

6. MEMBERSHIP COMMITTEE REPORT

Five new member applications are under review. David Nguyen reported two pending applications from trade finance firms and three from mid-size manufacturing exporters. Applications to be voted on at the next regular meeting. The total active membership currently stands at 312 firms and individuals.

7. NEW BUSINESS

Ray Hendricks raised the issue of port congestion at Toledo affecting member shipment timelines. The board agreed to submit a letter to the Port Authority requesting a stakeholder meeting. Kim and Hendricks to draft the letter for President Adkins's signature by the end of February.

8. NEXT MEETING

The next regular monthly board meeting is scheduled for October 15, 2026, 5:30 PM at the Midtown Conference Center, Room 214. President Adkins adjourned the meeting at 7:12 PM.

Respectfully submitted by: Priya Okonkwo, Secretary

Approved by the Board: February 19, 2026

Minutes Reference: CTA-BOARD-MIN-2026-02

ATTACHMENT A - FULL ATTENDANCE RECORD

Columbus Trade Association / Board of Directors Meeting / February 19, 2026

Board Members Present:

Name	Title / Organization	In Person / Remote	Signed In
Jason Robert Kim	Board Member; Managing Principal, Kim Trade	In Person	Yes
Carolyn Adkins	President, Adkins Global Trade LLC	In Person	Yes
Marcus Webb	Treasurer, Webb Import Solutions	In Person	Yes
Priya Okonkwo	Secretary, OhioAg Export Consulting	Remote	Yes
Ray Hendricks	Board Member, Hendricks Freight Partners	In Person	Yes
Teresa Bautista	Board Member, Central Ohio Manufacturers As	In Person	Yes
David Nguyen	Board Member, Nguyen Compliance Group	Remote	Yes
Carla Reyes	Executive Director, Columbus Trade Associatio	In Person	Yes

Members Absent: Two board members with prior notice. Quorum confirmed (7 of 8 present or remote). Minutes recorded by Priya Okonkwo, Board Secretary.

CTA Board Minutes February 19, 2026 Attachment A: Attendance Page 3

ATTACHMENT B - MOTIONS AND RESOLUTIONS LOG

Columbus Trade Association / Board of Directors Meeting / February 19, 2026

Motion No.	Description	Moved By	Seconded By	Vote	Result
2026-02-01	Approve January 2026 meeting minutes as distributed	M. Webb	R. Hendricks	7-0	Passed
2026-02-02	Approve Q4 2025 financial report and quarterly disbursement	M. Webb	C. Adkins	7-0	Passed
2026-02-03	Authorize 2026 Columbus Trade Mentorship Program Funding (\$1,200,000)	T. Bautista	T. Bautista	7-0	Passed
2026-02-04	Direct publication of member advisory on Section 301 tariff increases	P. Okonkwo	P. Okonkwo	6-1	Passed
2026-02-05	Approve fall 2026 annual membership dinner at Miami Seaquarium	C. Adkins	D. Nguyen	7-0	Passed
2026-02-06	Authorize RFP for new CTA website redesign, budget not to exceed \$100,000	T. Bautista	R. Hendricks	5-2	Passed

All motions recorded per Robert Rules of Order. Full transcript of deliberations on file with Board Secretary. Next scheduled meeting: October 15, 2026. See d2.docx for the Columbus Trade Mentorship Program annual summary referenced in

Motion 2026-02-03.

CTA Board Minutes February 19, 2026 Attachment B: Motions Page 4

ATTACHMENT C - COMMITTEE REPORTS AND FINANCIAL SUMMARY

Columbus Trade Association / Board Meeting / February 19, 2026

Membership Committee Report - submitted by Teresa Bautista:

Metric	Q4 2025	Q3 2025	Change	Notes
Total active members	312	301	+11	New member drive in Nov 2025 effective
New members this quarter	18	9	+9	
Renewals on time	89%	84%	+5pp	Email reminder sequence improved
Lapsed members	7	12	-5	Positive trend
Institutional members (firms)	47	44	+3	Three new firms in Q4

Finance Committee Report (Q4 2025) - submitted by Marcus Webb, Treasurer:

Line Item	Budget 2025	Actual 2025	Variance	Notes
Membership dues revenue	\$31,200	\$32,760	+\$1,560	New members above budget
Event and conference revenue	\$8,400	\$9,120	+\$720	Annual dinner sold out
Sponsorship income	\$6,000	\$5,500	-\$500	One sponsor did not renew
Total revenue	\$45,600	\$47,380	+\$1,780	
Program expenses (mentorship, events)	\$18,400	\$17,922	-\$478	Mentorship co-funded by KTS and Montoya
Administrative expenses	\$9,800	\$9,640	-\$160	Under budget
Total expenses	\$28,200	\$27,562	-\$638	
Net surplus	\$17,400	\$19,818	+\$2,418	To reserve fund

The 2025 surplus of \$19,818 will be transferred to the CTA operating reserve fund, bringing total reserves to \$64,300. The 2026 operating budget (approved in December 2025) projects \$48,200 in revenue and \$29,400 in expenses. See d2.docx for the Columbus Trade Mentorship Program 2025 annual summary referenced in this report.